SHEERAZ ZULFI

Site Reliability Engineer / DevOps Lead | Kubernetes & AWS · SLOs & Observability · Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Site Reliability / DevOps Lead with around **5 years** of experience running a hybrid **AWS and on-premise** platform of **20+ microservices** on Kubernetes. Owns reliability end to end: SLI/SLO-driven monitoring, incident response with RCA/post-mortems, Kubernetes upgrades, fault-tolerant design and **Python/Bash** automation. Cut deployment time by **50%**, sustained **99.9% uptime** and contributed to **SOC 2, ISO and VAPT** compliance. Strong in GitOps, observability, Kafka/MongoDB/Elasticsearch and LLM deployment; uses Claude, GitHub Copilot and Cursor with prompt engineering.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Reliability & SRE: SLIs/SLOs/SLAs, Error Budgets, Incident Response, RCA/Post-mortems, On-call, Runbooks, Capacity Planning, DR, Fault-tolerant Design
Containers & Orchestration: Kubernetes (upgrades, HPA, PDBs, probes, RBAC, Network Policies), EKS, Docker, Helm, k3s
Cloud (AWS): EC2, EKS, RDS, ELB/ALB, CloudFront, Lambda, S3, VPC, IAM, Route 53, CloudWatch
Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Ansible, Helm, GitOps
Monitoring & Observability: Prometheus, Alertmanager, Grafana, ELK/EFK, OpenTelemetry & Tracing, Slack Alerting
Linux & Networking: Linux troubleshooting, TCP/IP, DNS, TLS, HTTP/2, Nginx Load Balancing, Firewalls & DDoS Protection
CI/CD & GitOps: Jenkins, ArgoCD, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Maven, Git
Data Platforms: Kafka (Confluent), Elasticsearch, MongoDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Airflow
Security & Compliance: Keycloak (SSO/RBAC), SSL/TLS, MFA, Network Policies, SOC 2, ISO, VAPT
Programming & AI: Python, Bash, Java; Claude, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Prompt Engineering; Ollama, llama.cpp

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Lead | FireFlink, *Bengaluru, India* **Aug 2023 – Present**

- **Lead** infrastructure, reliability and release engineering for **20+ microservices** across **AWS and on-premise data centers**.
- **Executed Kubernetes cluster upgrades** with zero downtime: deprecation checks, etcd backups, rolling node upgrades, PDBs, staged rollout and rollback plan.
- **Defined SLIs/SLOs** and error budgets in Grafana, underpinning the **99.9% uptime** target.
- **Led incident response** and on-call; ran blameless **RCA/post-mortems** and turned findings into runbooks and automation.
- **Implemented** monitoring, alerting and logging (Prometheus, Alertmanager, Grafana, EFK, OpenTelemetry) with Slack alerts for pod restarts, CrashLoopBackOff and Kafka consumer lag.
- **Automated toil** with Python/Bash (health checks, certificate-expiry alerts, backup verification, self-healing) for faster recovery.
- **Built resilience and DR**: HPA, probes, anti-affinity, multi-AZ, capacity planning; backups and restore drills for MongoDB, Kafka and Elasticsearch against RTO/RPO targets.
- **Redesigned** Jenkins CI/CD (build-once, deploy-anywhere) across all environments, cutting deployment time by **50%**.
- **Built** HA Kubernetes with reusable Helm charts; **automated** ArgoCD GitOps, shipping **10+ AI services** and self-hosted LLMs.
- **Provisioned** AWS (EC2, EKS, RDS, ELB, VPC, IAM) with Terraform; migrated legacy applications to Docker.
- **Hardened security** (Keycloak RBAC, MFA, firewalls, DDoS protection), contributing to **SOC 2, ISO and VAPT** compliance.
- **Secured and scaled** MongoDB and Kafka (SSL, encryption); sharded Elasticsearch; led upgrades of MongoDB, Kafka, Elasticsearch and Keycloak; streamed MongoDB to Elasticsearch via Kafka Connect.
- **Configured** Nginx (TLS, reverse proxy, load balancing, HTTP/2), cutting backend CPU overhead by **30%**.
- **Partnered with development teams** on production-readiness and reliability onboarding (SLOs, alerting, runbooks); mentored, documented and reported status to stakeholders; used **AI assistants** to accelerate automation.

DevOps Engineer | TestYantra Software Solutions, *Bengaluru, India* **Mar 2022 – Aug 2023**

- **Migrated** a monolith to Docker microservices (Jenkins, Maven); **implemented Keycloak** (authentication, sessions, RBAC).
- **Integrated Kafka** for asynchronous messaging; **troubleshot** Linux, container and network issues; documented runbooks.

Planning Engineer | Shapoorji Pallonji & Co. Ltd, *Duqm Refinery Project (Oil & Gas), Oman* **Jul 2019 – Jul 2021**

- **Developed** an internal Project Management System (PMS) with automated reporting, daily MySQL backups and monitoring; produced Primavera P6 reports and risk analysis and coordinated cross-functional teams.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (Verify) • TestDome Java Certification (Verify) • CKA (in preparation)

EDUCATION

- **Post graduation in AI & ML** – University of Texas at Austin (Apr 2025 – Apr 2026) (Verify)
- **Bachelor of Engineering** – PES University, Bengaluru (2018)